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Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Enhance

The Best Yahoo! Widgets

There's a lot of junk on Yahoo's Widget Gallery, but we sifted through the lot to find you the 10 most useful widgets for your desktop

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Apple's Macintosh OS X popularised (apart from the cool gooey interface, of course) the concept of the widget—too small to be an application, but too big to be ignored. The widget sits on your desktop and performs a basic function—reading your news, checking the weather, and so on. Soon enough, these little buggers became the rage—it's tough to find a desktop without one. Still, most of the widgets you see are little but eye-candy—a pretty clock here, a calendar there—but there are a precious few that can really kick up your productivity. ■

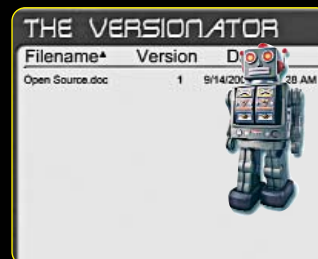
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The Versionator

<http://widgets.yahoo.com/gallery/view.php?widget=40238>

Ever wanted to go back in time see what a document was *before* things got crazy and you tried to ruin it with fancy words? All you need is the Versionator. You can use it to store different versions of your files with a comment for each version ("first draft," "second draft," and so on), and restore any of those versions any time you'd like to start over.

Just drag the file onto the silly-looking robot, add a comment, and your file goes straight into the repository. It lets you configure where you want to store the files, and if you select a mapped network drive, you've got yourself a handy versioning tool for the whole network. And you know you just want to tell someone, "Your file... has been Versionated."



Zoomy Space Dock

<http://widgets.yahoo.com/gallery/view.php?widget=39109>

If you're the type that has a million shortcuts on a double-thickness taskbar, the Zoomy Space Dock will help bring that clutter to your desktop in a more fun way. Just drag the programs you want to create shortcuts to into the docking space, and you've got yourself a bunch of bouncing shortcuts on your desktop. You can restrict their boundaries to save desktop real-estate, and turn the transparency all the way down to make them blend into the background. It's simple, fun, and solves all your shortcut needs!

